

Create Scripts

Scripts are the simplest kind of code file because they have no input or output arguments. They are useful for automating series of MATLAB® commands, such as computations that you have to perform repeatedly from the command line or series of commands you have to reference.

You can create a new script in the following ways:

- Highlight commands from the Command History, right-click, and select **Create Script**.
- On the **Home** tab, click the **New Script**  button.
- Use the edit function. For example, `edit new_file_name` creates (if the file does not exist) and opens the file `new_file_name`. If `new_file_name` is unspecified, MATLAB opens a new file called `Untitled`.

After you create a script, you can add code to the script and save it. For example, you can save this code that generates random numbers from 0 through 100 as a script called `numGenerator.m`.

```
columns = 10000;  
rows = 1;  
bins = columns/100;  
  
rng(now);  
list = 100*rand(rows,columns);  
histogram(list,bins)
```

Save your script and run the code using either of these methods:

- Type the script name on the command line and press **Enter**. For example, to run the `numGenerator.m` script, type `numGenerator`.
- On the **Editor** tab, click the **Run**  button.

You also can run the code from a second code file. To do this, add a line of code with the script name to the second code file. For example, to run the `numGenerator.m` script from a second code file, add the line `numGenerator;` to the file. MATLAB runs the code in `numGenerator.m` when you run the second file.

When execution of the script completes, the variables remain in the MATLAB workspace. In the `numGenerator.m` example, the variables `columns`, `rows`, `bins`, and `list` remain in the workspace. To see a list of variables, type `whos` at the command prompt. Scripts share the base workspace with your interactive MATLAB session and with other scripts.

See Also

Topics

[Create and Run Sections in Code](#)

[Scripts vs. Functions](#)

[Base and Function Workspaces](#)

[Create Live Scripts in the Live Editor](#)

